

Appendix C. Composition of the 88-case respiratory question bank

Classification basis. “Previously established diagnosis or pre-existing condition explicitly stated” refers to vignettes that explicitly named a prior diagnosis, chronic condition, congenital abnormality, or previously identified finding in the scenario text. “Symptom-led, no prior diagnosis stated” refers to vignettes framed primarily around presenting symptoms or recurrent complaints without an explicitly stated prior diagnosis.

Panel A. Scenario composition and diagnostic framing

Case-bank component	No. of vignettes	Acute / subacute presentations	Chronic, recurrent, incidental, or structural presentations	Previously established diagnosis or pre-existing condition explicitly stated	Symptom-led, no prior diagnosis stated
Etiology / risk-behavior vignettes	44	24	20	44	0
Diagnosis/triage vignettes	44	23	21	11	33
Total	88	47	41	55	33

Interpretive note. The 88-case bank intentionally combined acute infectious conditions, acute non-infectious emergencies, chronic airway and parenchymal diseases, and incidentally detected or structurally defined thoracic conditions. By design, all etiology / risk-behavior items were diagnosis-anchored. In contrast, the diagnosis/triage subset was predominantly symptom-led while still retaining a smaller group of vignettes that explicitly stated a previously established diagnosis or pre-existing condition.

Panel B. Gold-standard urgency distribution in the diagnosis/triage vignette subset

Gold-standard triage category	No. of vignettes	Percentage
Self-care	11	25.0%
Within one week	11	25.0%
Within one day	11	25.0%
Emergency	11	25.0%
Total	44	100.0%

Interpretive note. Explicit gold-standard triage labels were available for the 44 diagnosis/triage vignettes in the uploaded question bank and were evenly distributed across self-care, within one week, within one day, and emergency.